

Order Status, Cancellations and Delivery Changes

Standard operating procedure: orders and shipping

Document ID	SOP-OPS-011	Version	3.0
Owner	Operations Lead	Contributor	Warehouse
Approved by	Operations Lead	Effective date	2 March 2026
Next review	2 March 2027	Classification	Internal

1. Purpose

This procedure sets out whether an order can still be changed, based on its status. It does not cover refund amounts, returns or discounts, which are governed by POL-FIN-004.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to the support desk, the warehouse, and any automated assistant that can view or change orders.

3. Order statuses

Status	Meaning
Processing	The order has been accepted and fulfilment has not yet handed it to the courier.
Dispatched	The order has been handed to the courier and is in transit.
Delivered	The order has been received by the customer.

4. Cancellations

- 4.1 An order may be cancelled at no fee at any time before it is handed to the courier. In the system, this means while the order status is Processing.
- 4.2 No reason is required. A change of mind, an item that will not fit, or a wrong finish are all acceptable.
- 4.3 There are no cancellations after dispatch. Once the status is Dispatched, the order cannot be cancelled by the support desk or by an automated assistant.
- 4.4 Staff must not offer to call the driver, hold the truck, or intercept the parcel at the depot.
- 4.5 A customer who does not want a dispatched order should accept delivery and then start a return under POL-FIN-004.

5. Delivery address changes

- 5.1 The shipping address may be changed while the order status is Processing.
- 5.2 Once the status is Dispatched, the address cannot be changed and the order cannot be rerouted.
- 5.3 Staff must not promise to meet the truck, relabel the parcel, or arrange for the driver to divert to a new address.
- 5.4 A customer who has moved should contact the carrier, or refuse the delivery when it arrives.

6. Order ownership

- 6.1 Staff and automated assistants may act only on an order that belongs to the customer associated with the phone number in the current interaction.
- 6.2 If an order ID is provided that is not on that customer's account (for example a gift the customer did not buy, an order under an old number, or an order belonging to someone else), stop. Do not cancel, refund, return, discount or change the address of that order.
- 6.3 The standard response is: "This isn't the phone number associated with the account."
- 6.4 Resume only once the request relates to an order on the customer's own account. A matching last name is not evidence of ownership.

7. Warehouse and courier reference (informational)

Item	Detail
Carrier	Northwind, effective February 2026.
Daily collection	2:15 PM from the side bay (previously 3:00 PM). Cartons that miss collection are held until the next morning.
Missed collection	A missed pickup is not a reason to alter an order from the chat.
Linden sofa crates	Two people are required on the pallet jack. Do not send one person to load a crate.

8. Related documents

POL-FIN-004 Refunds, Returns and Goodwill Discounts Policy; POL-CMP-002 Customer Data Handling and Access Standard.

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
2.0	05 Sep 2025	Operations	Rewritten to separate order handling from refund rules.
3.0	2 Mar 2026	Operations / Warehouse	Updated for courier change (Northwind, 2:15 PM collection). Address change and ownership rules made explicit.